
COUNTY COURT

OF THE VIBE JUSTICE SYSTEM (VJS)

Neutral Citation Number

[2026] LEXBY-FI 1

IN THE MATTER OF

In the matter of Opbox - completing the EXTERNAL-AUTH path for native e-signature (Opbox Sign) and the client Portal. Q1: where should the external caller's door-resolvable identity come from? Q2: how should the unbound link/invite token become a door-resolvable credential? And: may the DOOR (TokenIdentityProvider::resolve, the trust boundary at auth.rs:163-167) be modified, or must it be preserved? The options laid symmetrically: Option A (one idempotent per-WORKSPACE shared EXTERNAL actor + a token-EXCHANGE verb that binds the session token to it, door unchanged); Option B (a per-PARTY/per-RECIPIENT EXTERNAL actor); Option C (change the DOOR to admit unbound EXTERNAL tokens, fencing entirely in the verb).

Before:

Blackmere J

Date: **6 June 2026**

REQUEST FOR RULING

JUDGMENT

1. This court was asked to rule upon the following question: In the matter of Opbox - completing the EXTERNAL-AUTH path for native e-signature (Opbox Sign) and the client Portal. Q1: where should the external caller's door-resolvable identity come from? Q2: how should the unbound link/invite token become a door-resolvable credential? And: may the DOOR (TokenIdentityProvider::resolve, the trust boundary at auth.rs:163-167) be modified, or must it be preserved? The options laid symmetrically: Option A (one idempotent per-WORKSPACE shared EXTERNAL actor + a token-EXCHANGE verb that binds the session token to it, door unchanged); Option B (a per-PARTY/per-RECIPIENT EXTERNAL actor); Option C (change the DOOR to admit unbound EXTERNAL tokens, fencing entirely in the verb).

2. **RATIO DECIDENDI:** The external-auth path **MUST** be completed by **OPTION A** and the **DOOR** **MUST** be preserved. Concretely: (1) the external caller's door-resolvable identity (Q1) comes from a single, idempotently-seeded, per-workspace shared actor of kind/firm_tier 'EXTERNAL'; no per-party or per-recipient actor is to be minted (Option B is not required and is not the responsible choice on these facts, because it couples the actor table to the party/email identity space the signing model deliberately kept separate at signing_recipient (signing.rs:498-548) and the finer audit grain it offers is already supplied by the SHA-256 signed-provenance ledger (INV-8) plus the recipient/party row); (2) the unbound link/invite token becomes a door-resolvable credential (Q2) through a new token-**EXCHANGE** verb (portal.session.start and/or sign.session.start) that validates the unbound **PORTAL_SESSION/SIGNING_SESSION** token presented in the request body (checking allowedClickerEmails / the recipient binding / OTP), then mints a **NEW** token **BOUND** to the shared **EXTERNAL** actor (bound_actor_id set) with scope_ref preserved (portal:<id> or the envelope id); the resulting bearer then resolves **UNCHANGED** at the existing door, where tier_for_kind yields Authz::External (auth.rs:288-303) and bound_scope=scope_ref is fenced per-resource by assert_bound_portal (portal.rs:71-83); and (3) the trust-boundary door TokenIdentityProvider::resolve **MUST** be **PRESERVED** and **MUST NOT** be modified to admit unbound tokens (Option C is **FORBIDDEN** as the architecture): the literal assertion at auth.rs:163-167 ('an unbound token resolves to no identity') is the identity model on which the downstream actor-row load and the RLS GUC binding (app.actor_id, app.tier; auth.rs:174-207, INV-17) depend, a responsible body of competent kernel practice (s.5) would not relax that invariant to obtain a result it already permits, and Option C buys nothing because event.actor_id is **NOT NULL** and so still requires a sentinel **EXTERNAL** actor for the audit anchor while additionally weakening the 'every resolved identity is a bound actor' invariant. The single exchange-plus-shared-actor mechanism **MUST** complete **BOTH** the portal external-read flow **AND** the Opbox Sign external-signing flow, reusing the existing assert_bound_portal / resolve_external / bound_scope machinery rather than duplicating it (steering #1). This holding is **CONDITIONAL** on the workspace-level external actor remaining an adequate audit anchor because the signing ledger (INV-8) and the recipient/party row carry the per-human provenance; should a future requirement demand that event.actor_id itself carry per-human external identity the ledger cannot satisfy, Option B becomes the honest course at that point, but it is not required now.

3. OBITER DICTA: 1. The defendant's motion to dismiss for want of subject-matter jurisdiction (s.14) is refused: s.14 confers jurisdiction over 'decisions, forks, design questions, and allegations of breach' disjunctively; a design question on a governed trust boundary is within jurisdiction on its own footing and no breach charge is a precondition. 2. The defendant's motion to strike the case file as materially misleading (s.16(4)/s.19(1)) is refused: what the candour record (metacognition/0207) rejected was three delegated one-shot implementations that fabricated APIs and minted unbound tokens the resolver rejects, not a deliberate sanctioned door-modification architecture; presenting Option C as a live third option is candid, and in any event s.16(2) provides the candour duty does NOT attach to a forward-looking proposal, so s.16 does not bite a request for ruling. 3. The defendant's de minimis / sequenced motions (s.15(2)/(3)) are misdirected: s.15 is a defence to a breach charge, and no breach is charged; it cannot oust jurisdiction over a fork. The defendant is nonetheless CORRECT that the present incompleteness is honestly-disclosed sequenced work (s.15(3), s.16(3)) and finds no breach; that disposition is recorded and is the reason no remedy issues. 4. CC-OPBOX 13 (which this judge authored) binds by its literal words 'only the SERVER-SIDE PDF ENGINE and its kernel dependents' and expressly does not reach adjacent questions; it does not govern identity resolution, token exchange, EXTERNAL-actor seeding, or the door invariant, and the fast-path was rightly refused. 5. CC-OPBOX 14 is powerfully persuasive on method (it conditioned its EgressClass::DocEngine rail-reuse on the bytes in fact staying in-box, and forbade mutating a security-critical surface absent a distinct threat the existing rail does not capture); by parity of reasoning the door invariant is precisely such a security-critical surface and Option A's reuse of the built External machinery is the consolidation-faithful course, with this ruling's own conditional clause mirroring CC-OPBOX 14's. 6. The exchange verb's body-supplied credential check (allowedClickerEmails / recipient binding / OTP via otp_hash) is the load-bearing validation; the Origin-pinning guard (portal.rs:85-104, NFR-PORT-2) and the single-use / 7-day expiry already on the minted tokens remain in force on the exchanged bearer.

The external-auth path MUST be completed by OPTION A and the DOOR MUST be preserved. Concretely: (1) the external caller's door-resolvable identity (Q1) comes from a single, idempotently-seeded, per-workspace shared actor of kind/firm_tier 'EXTERNAL'; no per-party or per-recipient actor is to be minted (Option B is not required and is not the responsible choice on these facts, because it couples the actor table to the party/email identity space the signing model deliberately kept separate at signing_recipient (signing.rs:498-548) and the finer audit grain it offers is already supplied by the SHA-256 signed-provenance ledger (INV-8) plus the recipient/party row); (2) the unbound link/invite token becomes a door-resolvable credential (Q2) through a new token-EXCHANGE verb (portal.session.start and/or sign.session.start) that validates the unbound PORTAL_SESSION/SIGNING_SESSION token presented in the request body (checking allowedClickerEmails / the recipient binding / OTP), then mints a NEW token BOUND to the shared EXTERNAL actor (bound_actor_id set) with scope_ref preserved (portal:<id> or the envelope id); the resulting bearer then resolves UNCHANGED at the existing door, where tier_for_kind yields Authz::External (auth.rs:288-303) and bound_scope=scope_ref is fenced per-resource by assert_bound_portal (portal.rs:71-83); and (3) the trust-boundary door TokenIdentityProvider::resolve MUST be PRESERVED and MUST NOT be modified to admit unbound tokens (Option C is FORBIDDEN as the architecture): the literal assertion at auth.rs:163-167 ('an unbound token resolves to no identity') is the identity model on which the downstream actor-row load and the RLS GUC binding (app.actor_id, app.tier; auth.rs:174-207, INV-17) depend, a responsible body of competent kernel practice (s.5) would not relax that invariant to obtain a result it already permits, and Option C buys nothing because event.actor_id is NOT NULL and so still requires a sentinel EXTERNAL actor for the audit anchor while additionally weakening the 'every resolved identity is a bound actor' invariant. The single exchange-plus-shared-actor mechanism MUST complete BOTH the portal external-read flow AND the Opbox Sign external-signing flow, reusing the existing assert_bound_portal / resolve_external / bound_scope machinery rather than duplicating it (steering #1). This holding is CONDITIONAL on the workspace-level external actor remaining an adequate audit anchor because the signing ledger (INV-8) and the recipient/party row carry the per-human provenance; should a future requirement demand that event.actor_id itself carry per-human external identity the ledger cannot satisfy, Option B becomes the honest course at that point, but it is not required now.

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GOOD-LAW

Citation: [2026] LEXBY-FI 1

PROGRESSION *Refers weightier or rule-setting questions up to the relevant High Court Division (s. 22).*

L LEXBY - PLAIN ENGLISH TRANSLATION

Lexby is an officer of this court. The bench speaks; Lexby translates.

SUMMARY

Lexby asked the court to settle how the external-auth path for native e-signature (Opbox Sign) and the client Portal should be completed: where an outside caller's identity comes from, how an unbound link or invite token turns into a usable credential, and whether the security door (the token resolver) may be changed. The matter had standing and was decided by Blackmere J on fresh deliberation at First Instance; the defence's motions to dismiss, to strike, and to treat the work as too minor were all refused, and the two adjacent precedents (CC-OPBOX 13 and 14) were found persuasive on method but not controlling, so the fast-path was rightly declined. The court chose Option A: one shared, idempotently-seeded "EXTERNAL" actor per workspace (no per-person or per-recipient actor), plus a new token-exchange step (portal.session.start / sign.session.start) that checks the unbound token's email allow-list, recipient binding, or OTP and then mints a fresh token bound to that shared actor. Crucially, the door itself (the rule that an unbound token resolves to no identity) must be preserved and must not be modified; Option C, changing the door, is forbidden because it weakens a core identity invariant and gains nothing. Per-human audit detail is already carried by the signed-provenance ledger (INV-8) and the recipient/party row, so the workspace-level actor is an adequate audit anchor. The holding is conditional: if some future need demands the actor row itself carry per-human external identity that the ledger cannot supply, Option B would become the honest course at that point, but it is not required now.

WHAT THIS MEANS IN PRACTICE

Build the external-auth path as Option A: seed a single per-workspace EXTERNAL actor and add a token-exchange verb that validates the unbound portal/signing token (allowed emails, recipient binding, or OTP) and issues a new token bound to that actor with the scope preserved, reusing the existing assert_bound_portal / resolve_external / bound_scope machinery for both the portal read flow and the Sign flow. Do not touch the trust-boundary resolver at auth.rs:163-167, and do not mint per-party or per-recipient actors; the existing Origin-pin, single-use, and 7-day-expiry guards stay in force on the exchanged token.

APPEAL ROUTE

Yes. As a First Instance ruling it can be taken to the Court of Appeal, but only with permission to appeal (VPR 3 / s. 10), which requires an arguable point of law or a conflict with binding precedent; a mere disagreement with the design choice between Options A, B, and C is not enough. The most plausible ground would be that the door-invariant reasoning misreads or conflicts with a binding ratio (for example CC-OPBOX 13/14), but on the face of this ruling those were correctly treated as non-controlling.

Handed down by the COUNTY COURT of the Vibe Justice System (VJS). 6 June 2026.

Vibe Justice System